

ASHIMA SITAULA, PhD

Instructional Designer & Learning Experience Designer | AI Literacy Programs

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer and program leader with 10+ years building scalable education systems across K–12, higher education, and community organizations — and a computing degree, which means designing curriculum and then building it rather than handing off a spec. PhD in Curriculum & Instruction with a research focus on technology integration and learner engagement. Currently reaching ~4,000 learners annually across 10+ distributed sites. Translates complex technical goals into modular learning content — from AI literacy programs and instructor enablement systems to open-source courses built through human-AI collaboration. Manages end-to-end program lifecycles from stakeholder discovery through deployment and data-driven iteration.

EXPERIENCE

Curriculum Manager

Jun 2025 – Present

Code For Fun • Sunnyvale, CA • Promoted from Curriculum Designer (Contract), Dec 2024 – Jun 2025

- Lead end-to-end curriculum strategy for CS and STEAM programs reaching ~4,000 learners annually across distributed after-school and camp sites
- Design scalable curriculum development processes with structured review cycles, defined success metrics, and rollout frameworks ensuring quality across 10+ sites
- Built instructor enablement and onboarding system supporting 50+ educators per season, increasing implementation fidelity and instructional effectiveness
- Develop seasonal program roadmaps aligned with enrollment targets, partner timelines, and organizational priorities
- Drive continuous improvement through classroom observation, feedback loops, pilot testing, and cross-functional collaboration with operations and marketing

Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant

Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

Indiana State University — Dept. of Teaching & Learning • Terre Haute, IN

- Served as teaching assistant for undergraduate courses, supporting instruction and student learning
- Conducted qualitative research on learner engagement and access to drive evidence-based instructional decisions

Graduate Assistant

Aug 2021 – Jul 2023

Office of the President & Provost, Indiana State University • Terre Haute, IN

- Created comprehensive training manual and social media guidelines for university managers
- Developed interactive SoftChalk learning modules for the university's Online Teaching Certificate program
- Managed university communications including ISU Today announcements and calendar publishing

Curriculum Developer

Dec 2020 – Aug 2021

Hands In Outreach (HIO) • Sheffield, MA

- Designed a 3-year adult literacy curriculum serving 150+ women in Nepal, progressing from foundational literacy to digital skills
- Created Career Days program connecting high school girls to education and career pathways (50+ participants)
- Built community-based delivery models aligned with local capacity and sustainability goals

Computer Teacher & Education Technologist

Apr 2014 – Nov 2018

Lalitpur Secondary Boarding School • Lalitpur, Nepal

- Taught computer science courses (Grades 5–6) and introduced Scratch programming for younger students
- Integrated educational technology into classroom instruction; provided technical support and training for faculty
- Organized annual IT & Communication Fair and co-coordinated the first Students Quality Circle Convention in Lalitpur

EDUCATION

May 2026

PhD in Curriculum & Instruction

Indiana State University

Dec 2020

MS in Educational Technology

Indiana State University

Sep 2017

BSc Hons in Computing (IT)

London Metropolitan University

SKILLS

Instructional Design: ADDIE, SAM, Backward Design, UDL, Needs Assessment, Kirkpatrick Evaluation, Competency Frameworks, Microlearning, Storyboarding

Tools: Articulate 360, SoftChalk, Camtasia, Adobe Captivate, Canvas LMS, Blackboard, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Python, SQL, SCORM, Git/GitHub

AI & Technology: AI Literacy & Enablement, Human-AI Collaboration, Claude Code, LLM Integration, Prompt Engineering for Education

Leadership: Program Management, Stakeholder Alignment, Instructor Enablement, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Data-Driven Iteration

SELECTED PROJECTS

Zero to Live: Building with Claude Code — Built an 11-page portfolio using an AI agent, then documented the process as a free interactive course. 48 repo clones in the first week. Features progress tracking, collapsible lessons, and interactive checklists.

AI Decoded: An AI/ML Crash Course — Built a 6-lesson interactive course teaching AI fundamentals to curious professionals, with knowledge checks, progress tracking, and completion gating. Designed and developed solo through human-AI collaboration.

Scalable CS & STEAM Curriculum System — Designed multi-format training programs reaching ~4,000 learners annually and delivering 49,000+ student instruction hours across 10+ distributed sites.

3-Year Community Literacy System — Designed a longitudinal learning pathway for 150+ women progressing from foundational literacy to digital skills, with a replicable framework for community-based delivery.

PUBLICATIONS

Sitaula, A. (2026). *The Experience of South Asian International Students in Online Classes* (Publication No. 32701309) [Doctoral dissertation, Indiana State University]. ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global.

Sitaula, A. (2024). "The Kaleidoscope of Connections." In *Bridging Cultures, Empowering Futures: Global Citizenship and International Education* (pp. 15-18). STAR Scholar Press.

Sitaula, A., & Sitaula, G. (2021). "Lap of Mount Everest Our Lab of Learning." In *World of Children* (pp. 181-202). Linton Atlantic Books.